Secretary H.V. Seshadri castigates the Vajpayee government for its ‘tandav [dance of death] of corruption’.

September 2000: The RSS’s Swadeshi Jagran Manch (SJM) opposes the Vajpayee government’s ban on the sale of non-iodised salt; says it would play into the hands of MNCs. On 12 September, the Vajpayee government withdrew its ban.

15 October 2000: L.K. Advani says that the ‘RSS exercises a moral influence on the government and both Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee and I share a historical bonding with it’.

October 2000: RSS chief K.S. Sudarshan accuses Christian missionaries of using the north-eastern states to establish ‘military bases’ in ‘strategic areas’ to work against India. Calls for a new ‘Indian’ church, asking Christians to set up an indigenous church, delinked from foreign churches.

16 March 2001: RSS announces major membership-expansion programme.

7 October 2001: Narendra Modi becomes Gujarat chief minister.

27 February 2002: Fifty-seven kar-sevaks returning from Ayodhya are burnt to death in the Sabarmati Express at the Godhra railway station after an altercation.

28 February–June 2002: Communal riots in Gujarat.

22 December 2002: Modi wins his first Gujarat election as a sitting CM.

2003: RSS starts organising software shakhas or ‘IT Milans’.

2004: Vajpayee calls polls six months ahead of schedule, loses elections. The Congress-led UPA comes to power. Manmohan Singh becomes prime minister.

2004: The BJP wins an absolute majority of Lok Sabha seats in Karnataka, the start of a pattern that continues till 2019.

2004: The BJP becomes the single largest party in the Karnataka assembly for the first time, Yediyurappa becomes the first BJP deputy CM in the South in an alliance government with JD(S).

2 July 2004: Shiksha Bachao Andolan Samiti (SBAS) set up by the RSS’s Dinanath Batra. Files eleven cases in court, wins all of them: